

Acme Corp — Employee Handbook

1. Leave Policy

Employees are entitled to 18 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, accrued monthly at 1.5 days per month. Unused leave up to 10 days may be carried forward to the next year; any excess is forfeited. Leave requests must be submitted at least 3 working days in advance via the HR portal, except in emergencies.

2. Maternity Leave Policy

Female employees are entitled to 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for the first two children, and 12 weeks for the third child onward, in accordance with applicable labor law. Maternity leave may begin up to 8 weeks before the expected delivery date. Employees must notify HR at least 60 days before the leave starts, along with a medical certificate confirming the expected delivery date. On return, employees are guaranteed the same or an equivalent role and salary.

3. Paternity Leave Policy

Male employees are entitled to 2 weeks of paid paternity leave, to be taken within 3 months of the child's birth or adoption. Requests must be submitted to HR at least 2 weeks in advance where possible.

4. Sick Leave Policy

Employees receive 12 paid sick leave days per year. A medical certificate is required for sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive days. Sick leave does not carry forward to the next calendar year.

5. Work From Home Policy

Employees may work from home up to 2 days per week, subject to manager approval. Roles requiring on-site presence (e.g., lab, manufacturing) are excluded from this policy. Employees must remain reachable during standard working hours (9:30 AM to 6:30 PM) on WFH days.

6. Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to act with integrity, respect confidentiality of company and client data, and avoid conflicts of interest. Harassment or discrimination of any kind is strictly prohibited and will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

7. Expense Reimbursement Policy

Business-related expenses (travel, client meals, approved software) are reimbursed within 15 working days of submission through the finance portal. Claims must be submitted with original receipts within 30 days of the expense being incurred. Expenses without receipts above INR 500 will not be reimbursed.

8. Termination and Notice Period

Employees are required to serve a notice period of 60 days upon resignation. The company may, at its discretion, provide pay in lieu of notice. During the probation period (first 6 months of employment), the notice period is reduced to 15 days for both employee and employer.